Arolygiaeth Gofal Cymru
Care Inspectorate Wales

Inspection Report on

Ty Canol

Llanelli

Date Inspection Completed

5th October 2022

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About Ty Canol

Type of care provided	Care Home Service Childrens Home
Registered Provider	Priority Childcare Limited
Registered places	1
Language of the service	English
Previous Care Inspectorate Wales inspection	26th October 2021
Does this service provide the Welsh Language active offer?	This service is working towards providing an 'Active Offer' of the Welsh language and demonstrates a significant effort to promoting the use of the Welsh language and culture.

Summary

Ty Canol is a children's home providing care and support for young people.

At the previous inspection, significant shortfalls were identified, and we issued seven Priority Action Notices and two Areas for Improvement in relation to the care and support of young people, the environment and Leadership and Management of the service. At this inspection, we found the service provider has taken action to address the regulatory breaches to ensure good quality care and support for young people is being provided.

The service closed for a period of review and now provides young people with a full complement of permanent care staff who have received adequate training. Care staff told us there has been significant change within the leadership and management and it is a positive place to work.

Young people are beginning to form positive relationships with care staff and although they do not always actively engage, care staff encourage young people to reach their potential and demonstrate a desire to improve the well-being of young people

Well-being

Young people are provided with a children's guide to the service to ensure they can access the right information when they need it. The guide provides important information around how they will spend their time at Ty Canol, advocacy, and information regarding the complaints process.

The service promotes the voice of young people and provides regular opportunities to express their views through individual discussion and house meetings. Key worker sessions are completed monthly although the content still requires improvement. Young people are provided with monthly questionnaires to share their views and engage in monthly house meetings. When young people make requests about their care they are provided with an outcome. Family visits are encouraged and supported.

Young people are not developing and learning to their potential and do not routinely attend education. Records show, care staff encourage young people to attend school, create healthy sleep routines and plan fun and engaging activities they will enjoy but there is little engagement from young people. Care staff, external professionals and family members work together to support young people's engagement. Young people are registered with universal health services and the service supports young people to access further specialist services when appropriate. Young people have a user-friendly health plan to help them understand their health needs.

A healthy lifestyle is promoted by care staff and a varied and balanced menu is offered to young people. Care staff complete two monthly menus to promote choice and autonomy, but records show young people often decline these options and will choose unhealthy options more frequently.

The service ensures young people are safe from risk of harm. Care staff have received safeguarding training and are confident in following suitable safeguarding processes. Safeguarding referrals are submitted within the required time frame and a chronology of the incident is recorded. Incidents reports are detailed and provide important information including the managers review. Physical intervention is rarely needed, however, appropriately used when required. After serious incidents, young people are offered a debrief, however records show young people do not always engage.

Care and Support

Provider assessments assess the needs of young people and provide assurances to commissioners and external professionals care staff can meet those assessed care and support needs. Provider assessments are routinely reviewed and updated; however, improvement is needed to ensure the service provides detail on how young people will be supported whilst living at Ty Canol. Impact risk assessments are completed to ensure all young people can live together safely.

Young people have personal plans which identify their needs and focus on their well-being outcomes to ensure care staff can provide the right care and support as early as possible. Care staff record young people's voice and wishes, although engagement is limited. The service has created outcome status logs to motivate young people on their accomplishments and to record why and how outcomes may have changed. Care staff told us they would like young people to engage more. Monthly evaluations capture consultation with young people and are focused on their personal well-being outcomes. Care should be taken to ensure records represent the training care staff have received.

Behaviour support plans are detailed and describe how care staff should support young people to reduce risky or challenging behaviours. Important information including triggers and preventative strategies ensure care staff follow safe practices and young people are treated with dignity and their individual circumstances are considered. Risk assessments are in place which include known risk behaviours and are reviewed and updated with new information.

Daily recordings are focused on young people's well-being outcomes and care staff evidence the care and support provided and any progress made. As engagement from young people can be limited, daily recordings should ensure care staff capture all interaction and safety checks they have carried out. We saw care staff engaging positively with young people and encouraging them to have breakfast and get ready for school.

Young people are supported to take prescribed medication which best supports their physical and mental health. Medication records detail the prescribed medication and if young people decline. The medication cabinet is secure, and the temperature is recorded daily.

All non-compliance in relation to the care and support of young people has been met.

Environment

Young people live in a home conducive of a family home. Since the last previous inspection, the service has ensured the home is clean, well maintained and decorated to a good standard. Young people have space for socialising and privacy both within the home and the external grounds.

Young people are encouraged to personalise their bedrooms to create a sense of belonging. Young people have photos of their family around the home, and there is a wide range of DVDs, games, and toys within the living room to support the young people to play, learn and relax.

The service protects young people from risks by completing necessary fire and health and safety checks. Effective health and safety manager checks, and recordings provide assurances to young people that when any issues arise, maintenance work is completed quickly, and their environment is safe from risk. Visitors are required to sign in and provide identification when entering Ty Canol.

Non-compliance in relation to the environment has been met.

Leadership and Management

The service being provided to young people reflects the statement of purpose, and the provider has taken action to address the shortfalls in relation to the leadership and management of the service.

The service has recently created a new management structure to ensure suitable oversight and support for young people as the team, work across two homes within a minutes' walk from each other. The manager is supported by a deputy and a full complement of care staff. There is no longer a requirement to use agency staff and care staff rota's show required staffing ratios are met.

Young people are supported by suitably trained and supervised care staff to ensure they receive their assessed care and support needs. Training records show nearly all care staff have completed mandatory training in line with the statement of purpose however care staff told us some training such as Positive Behaviour Management (PBM) could be improved. Care staff receive monthly supervision to ensure they can reflect on practise and provide good quality care and support to young people. Supervision records demonstrated purposeful dialogue, praise, and areas to action. Care staff told us the management team are very supportive and they are confident in working with young people.

The service provider has completed safe recruitment checks to provide assurances to young people they are cared for by suitable care staff. Recruitment and personnel files demonstrate regulatory checks including, the verification of references, identification, and checks to the Disclosure and Barring Service (DBS) are completed.

The Responsible Individual (RI) has suitable arrangements in place to assess and improve the quality of the service for young people. Records of regulatory visits demonstrate consultation, through informal discussion and questionnaires, checks on the environment and a review of documentation. Improvements and recommendations are recorded within regulatory visits and the Quality-of-care report. Care staff told us the RI visits frequently and is approachable. Regular manager audits are completed on medication charts, training records, and health and safety to provider further scrutiny and review.

All non-compliance in relationship to the leadership and management of this service has been met.

Summary of Non-Compliance	
Status	**What each means**
New	This non-compliance was identified at this inspection.
Reviewed	Compliance was reviewed at this inspection and was not achieved. The target date for compliance is in the future and will be tested at next inspection.
Not Achieved	Compliance was tested at this inspection and was not achieved.
Achieved	Compliance was tested at this inspection and was achieved.

We respond to non-compliance with regulations where poor outcomes for people, and / or risk to people's well-being are identified by issuing Priority Action Notice (s).

The provider must take immediate steps to address this and make improvements. Where providers fail to take priority action by the target date we may escalate the matter to an Improvement and Enforcement Panel.

Priority Action Notice(s)		
Regulation	Summary	Status
N/A	No non-compliance of this type was identified at this inspection	N/A
34	Young people are not cared for by a permanent team of care staff who have the experience, knowledge and skills to meet their needs.	Achieved
60	The service provider has not informed CIW of notifiable events as per regulations.	Achieved
80	Quality assurance measures are not sufficiently robust.	Achieved
6	The service is not operating in line with it's statement of purpose.	Achieved
21	Young people are not cared for by a consistent team of care staff who are able to promote and maintain	Achieved

	their safety and wellbeing.	
15	Young people do not have a current personal plan which provides a detailed record of how their needs are to be met.	Achieved
69	The manager oversees two services which is impacting on the health and wellbeing of young people.	Achieved

Where we find non-compliance with regulations but no immediate or significant risk for people using the service is identified we highlight these as Areas for Improvement.

We expect the provider to take action to rectify this and we will follow this up at the next inspection. Where the provider has failed to make the necessary improvements we will escalate the matter by issuing a Priority Action Notice.

Area(s) for Improvement		
Regulation	Summary	Status
N/A	No non-compliance of this type was identified at this inspection	N/A
77	Young people's files are difficult to follow and incidents are recorded in different places.	Achieved
43	The environment was not welcoming and requires some repairs and re-decoration. Safety checks were not always completed.	Achieved

Date Published 21/10/2022